

Seeing the System

Making work visible

KANBAN BOARD

Pulse Works Sprint Board — Week 4

Project: Kurosawa Digital XR Platform | **Sprint:** 4 of 12 | **Date:** Week 4, Month 2

TO DO	IN PROGRESS	REVIEW	DONE
AR filter module Yuki	VR rendering engine Tetsu	API auth layer Tetsu	DB schema v2 Maki
Admin portal UI Yuki	Catalog API endpoints Tetsu	iOS SDK integration Tetsu	User auth service Maki
Analytics pipeline Unassigned	Android client shell Tetsu		Design system v1 Yuki

*Hina drew this board on the office whiteboard. She stepped back, counted the green name tags, and went quiet. Three items in progress, two in review — all five assigned to Tetsu. Everyone else had one item or none. The entire **flow** of work through the system was funneling through a single person.*

Hina (陽菜) "Tetsu, you have five cards. Everyone else has one or zero. That's... that can't be right, can it?"

Tetsu (哲) "It's accurate."

Ren stared at the board. He'd assigned most of those items himself. The guilt landed quietly, like a door closing.

Flow

DEFINITION The movement of work through a system from start to finish.

COMPONENTS Work items entering the system, progression through stages, exit as completed output, speed and smoothness of movement.

RELATED TERMS critical path, dependency, value stream

EXAMPLE The sprint board reveals that flow is blocked at "In Progress" and "Review" — both stages are jammed because Tetsu owns every item there.

Feedback Loop

DEFINITION A mechanism for receiving information about output to improve process.

COMPONENTS Output signal, measurement, comparison to goal, corrective action.

RELATED TERMS flow, **earned value**, continuous learning

EXAMPLE The Kanban board itself is a feedback loop — it made the work imbalance visible, giving the team information they can act on.

Continuous Learning

DEFINITION The practice of ongoing experimentation and knowledge sharing.

COMPONENTS Experimentation, failure as data, knowledge sharing, process adaptation.

RELATED TERMS feedback loop, flow, **planned value**

EXAMPLE Hina's decision to draw the board was an experiment — she didn't know what she'd find. The result is organizational learning the team can build on.

Value Stream

DEFINITION The sequence of activities required to deliver value to a customer.

COMPONENTS Request intake, development stages, review and approval, delivery to customer.

RELATED TERMS flow, **WBS**, **scope baseline**

EXAMPLE For the XR platform, the value stream runs from feature request through development, review, and deployment. Every column on the board represents a stage in that stream.

Lead Time (Process)

DEFINITION The total time from work request to work delivery.

COMPONENTS Queue time (waiting), active work time, review/approval time, handoff time.

RELATED TERMS flow, value stream, **lead time**

EXAMPLE The API auth layer has been in "Review" for days because Tetsu — its reviewer — is also building three other items. The lead time stretches not because the work is hard, but because the wait is long.